

SURENDRA SINGH RAWAT

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Executive Chef with over sixteen years of experience, 9+ years leading Indian restaurants. Culinary artist with expertise in: Hospitality Management, Pastry Arts, Indian & Western Baking, North Indian & Indo-Chinese cuisine. Published research on the College of Dupage digital commons. A personal profile and recipes featured in professional newspapers, websites and other publications. Member of the American Culinary Federation. Committed to community outreach, sharing expertise through YouTube, free cooking demonstrations, and literary pursuits, including a forthcoming cookbook and chef memoir.

CULINARY TRAINING

I trained in general/basic cooking from small street restaurants (Dhaba's) to luxurious hotels in New Delhi and other north Indian states. I learned kitchen services, food preparation, and restaurant operations. I was also exposed to various cuisines such as: Indian, Continental, Chinese, and International. I concentrated on world cuisine under the supervision of experienced chefs, including planning menus, outdoor catering, labor costing, estimating food requirements, measuring and mixing ingredients, and stocking kitchen utensils, equipment and supplies.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

RAWAT FOODS INC. DBA India Palace Restaurant (Wheaton, Illinois, USA)

Executive Chef

February 2017 - Current

In order to hold this position and oversee kitchen operations as a culinary expert, I showcase this mixture of vision and skills:

- Craft and curate unique recipes/menus that tell the story of Indian culinary heritage.
- Formulate consistently eye-appealing plates through innovative experimentation.
- Evaluate profitable price points.
- Execute time and temperature standards.
- Interact with guests/customers, discovering and fulfilling their unique desires.
- Train staff for sanitation & accident prevention.
- Assure customers that the food is created "with the safest hands"—maintaining the highest standards of food quality and safety.
- Know staff's innovative capabilities for maximum productivity and high standards of excellence.
- Foster a culture of collaboration, mentoring, and professional and personal growth among the kitchen staff.
- Procure components for all recipes, negotiating with vendors to secure the finest quality ingredients.
- Continually inventory recipe ingredients, cooking supplies, and equipment, while also anticipating the future needs of an extensive menu.

- Establish food wastage control.
- Ensure customer satisfaction, respond to feedback, and show empathy and hospitality.
- Establish and maintain a record-keeping system of health-and safety-related procedures.

Wildflower Hall (The Oberoi Group of Hotels & Resorts) (Shimla, Himachal Pradesh, India)

Commis Chef

November 2014 - February 2017

As a member of a food production department with a 'supervisory role', I lead my kitchen as follows:

- Prepared breakfast and bulk production for parties/special events.
- Baked pastries.
- Controlled food costs without compromising the food quality.
- Supervised the team to get productive results.
- Trained subordinates.
- Organized food procurement.
- Inventoried food ingredients and supplies.

Hotel Radisson Windsor (Jalandhar, Punjab, India)

Commis Chef

August 2013 - November 2014

As a Commis chef, I experienced the big picture of a kitchen and learned to fulfill responsibilities such as:

- Working with food preparation and basic cooking under the supervision of a section chef.
- Developing daily requisitions for the departmental food ingredients.
- Maintaining Store inventory records.
- Assisting senior chefs in bulk cooking.

Hotel Radisson Windsor (Jalandhar, Punjab, India)

In Job Training

August 2012 - August 2013

- Reordered kitchen store.
- Helped chefs in bulk production.
- Prepared Mise en place.

Country Inn & Suites by Carlson (Sahibabad, Uttar Pradesh, India)

Industrial Training

November 2011 - May 2012

Assisted in four major departments of hotel operations, including Front Desk, Housekeeping, Food Production and Food and Beverage Service. Learned to understand the hotel's standard operating procedures and policies. Ensured guest satisfaction and handled guest complaints as needed.

EDUCATION

Bachelor Degree In Hotel Management (BBA-HM)

Sam Higginbottom University of Agriculture, Technology and Sciences, Allahabad, Uttar Pradesh, India (2012)

PROFESSIONAL CERTIFICATIONS

- August 6, 2024 - Illinois Food Allergen Course Certification. Certificate Verification Number: 1fg8b6-k1iad3c.
- June 30, 2024 - American Culinary Federation Membership Certificate. ID CARD.
- February 26, 2024 - Microsoft Office Specialist Certification. Verify here: G7pk-uSRW.
- February 03, 2025 - Illinois Food Manager Course Certification. Certificate Verification Number: 26882868.
- October 31, 2016 - Supervisory Development Program certification from The Oberoi Centre of Learning and Development.

RESEARCH AND PUBLICATIONS

- **The Mountain Kitchen: A Journey from a Himalayan Village to an American Kitchen** | Chef Surendra Singh Rawat Book. Amazon.com eBook.
- **Article: Ancient Flavours, Global Future: How Himalayan Cuisine Is Emerging as the Next Global Trend.** Published on March 2, 2026, in RestaurantIndia.in.
- **Article: Why Himalayan Cuisine Is Emerging as the Next Global Trend.** Published on February 28, 2026, in HospiBuz.com.
- **Article: Why millennials and Gen Z are driving the demand for green salads.** Published on September, 19, 2025, in HansIndia.com.
- **Article: How Veganism is Reshaping the Global Hospitality Industry.** Published in Hotelier India magazine on July 13, 2025.
- **Published research paper (3370+ downloads worldwide):** The Impact of Social Media Reviews on Restaurants Business by College of DuPage, Glen Ellyn, Illinois, on digital common platform.

ACHIEVEMENTS

- **Bronze Medal Recipient - American Culinary Federation (ACF) National Convention 2026 | Chef Culinary Creation Category (June 30, 2026):** Earned a Bronze Medal in the Chef Culinary Creation competition held during the ACF National Convention and organized in collaboration with the World Food Championships.
- Featured in the May/June 2026 issue of the National Culinary Review (NCR page no.6), the official national publication of the American Culinary Federation.
- Invited as a Culinary Judge for the FCCLA State-Level Culinary Competition at the College of DuPage on March 27, 2026.
- Received a Letter of Appreciation from Wheaton Public Library for conducting an Indian Street Food Culinary Demonstration on March 3, 2026.
- Received a Letter of Appreciation from the Billy Graham Scholarship Program at Wheaton College for providing catering services and culinary support for the 50th Anniversary "To the Nations Among Us" event on February 21, 2026.
- Invited and served as an Industry Judge for the SkillsUSA Regional Baking & Pastry Competition at Area Career Center, Hammond, IN, on February 7, 2026.
- Featured in Amar Ujala Dehradun, January 2026.
- Featured in the New India abroad, September 28, 2025.

- Represented India Palace Restaurant, Wheaton, IL, as Executive Chef at an invitation-only Illinois Restaurant Association Industry Roundtable with CEO Sam Toia, held on August 21, 2025.
- Invited as a local Executive Chef and demonstrated at the 15th Annual Veggie Fest Chicago on August 9, 2025.
- Featured in Chefs without Borders in August 2025.
- Hospitalitynews Feature | August 2025. Chef Surendra Rawat Showcases Uttarakhand Cuisine.
- Featured in the American Culinary Federation (ACF) Chicago Chapter President's Newsletter, April 2025.
- Recognized as an Honored Listee in Marquis Who's Who in America, forthcoming in the 2025-2026 publication.
- Featured in the American Culinary Federation (ACF) Chicago Chapter President's Newsletter, March 2024.
- Featured as a Member Spotlight on the American Culinary Federation (ACF) Chicago Chapter website.
- My traditional Indian recipes, "Chicken Tikka" and "Saag Paneer", were showcased on the American Culinary Federation (ACF) Chicago Chapter website.
- Featured Profile and Recipe: My authentic North Indian recipe, "Barnyard Millet ki Kheer," was showcased in the February issue of Diaspora Connect USA magazine.
- Received a Letter of Appreciation on Feb. 22, 2025, from the American Culinary Federation (ACF) Chicago Chefs for hosting culinary educational program event.
- Featured on Food Industry News Chicago's Facebook page (February 22, 2025) for hosting the American Culinary Federation (ACF) Chicago Chefs' monthly meeting.
- Featured in the American Culinary Federation (ACF) Chicago Chefs' February 2025 Newsletter.
- Featured Recipe, Diaspora Connect USA Monthly Magazine, First Published Edition, January 2025.
- Received a Letter of Appreciation from the Cricket Association for the Blind in India (December 24, 2024).
- Culinary Expertise Recognition: Received letter of recommendation on September 27, 2024, from South Asian Friendship Center (SAFC), Chicago.
- Earned recommendation from Dr. Lindy Scott, Professor Emeritus of Spanish and Latin American Studies at Whitworth University on September 19, 2024.
- Featured Profile: India Tribune, Chicago, Page 10 (September 13, 2024).
- Featured Profile: Food Industry News Chicago, October 2024 issue.
- Featured in the American Culinary Federation (ACF) Chicago Chapter President's Newsletter (September 2024).
- Recognized for outstanding culinary service by IUSA Media for hosting the Indian Men's Cricket Team for the Blind at India Palace Restaurant, Wheaton, IL (2024).
- Recipient of the Award of Excellence for Outstanding Culinary Skills (Summerfest, 2024) by Desi Junction.
- Appreciation certificate from Theosophical Society USA for participation in TheosoFest in Wheaton, Illinois in 2017.
- Certificate Of Participation in The Golden Crust - Patisserie and Boulangerie Conclave 2 (2016).
- Received an appreciation certificate for dedication given to Wildflower Hall (2015).
- Certificate of Excellence, Office of the Chief Minister, Uttarakhand, India (2014).
- Excellent performance certificate from Amazon Institute of Hotel Management Noida in October 2012.

COOKING DEMONSTRATIONS

Dedicated to giving back to the community, I have generously volunteered my time and culinary expertise to conduct multiple cooking demonstrations at various local organizations, including Glen Ellyn's Faith Lutheran Church, Carol Stream Public Library, and People's Resource Center Wheaton.

- **American Culinary Federation (ACF) National Convention - Educational Speaker & Culinary Demonstrator | July 01, 2026:** Presented "Flavors of the Himalayas," demonstrating the cultural heritage and techniques behind traditional Himalayan cuisine.
- **American Culinary Federation (ACF) Chef's Table Webinar Presenter | June 10, 2026:** Presented the live educational webinar "Emerging Flavors" for the American Culinary Federation, showcasing the culinary heritage of the Himalayan region of Uttarakhand, India.
- **Indian Street Food Educational Demonstration - Wheaton Public Library | March 3, 2026:** Conducted an educational culinary demonstration featuring Dahi Bhalla, Pani Puri, and Papdi Chaat, showcasing authentic Indian street food traditions.
- **Veggie Fest Chicago - Educational Culinary Demonstration | August 9, 2025:** Participated as a demo chef at the 15th Annual Veggie Fest Chicago, presenting traditional Indian and Himalayan cuisine.
- **American Culinary Federation (ACF) Chicago Chefs - Educational Culinary Demonstration | May 12, 2025:** Presented an educational cooking demonstration featuring Tandoori Duck, showcasing the application of traditional Indian spices.
- **Carol Stream Public Library - Educational Culinary Demonstration | May 16, 2023:** Conducted a community cooking demonstration as a Pastry Expert and Executive Chef, showcasing professional pastry techniques through a no-bake cheesecake demonstration.
- **Faith Lutheran Church ESL Cooking Program - Glen Ellyn | April 18, 2023:** Conducted an educational Indian cooking demonstration for ESL students and community participants.
- **People's Resource Center (PRC) Employee Culinary Demonstration - Wheaton | August 22, 2023:** Conducted a cooking demonstration for PRC employees, showcasing Broccoli and Cheese Kebab.

PERSONAL INFORMATION

Date of birth:	January 1, 1991
Nationality:	Indian
Marital status:	Married
References:	Available on request